Arboretum Green Hotel

Website Handoff and Operating Guide

Prepared by Tenex
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What was built, what it costs to run, how ownership moves to the hotel, and how to request help after the unveiling of Sun 15 November 2026.

Confidential. Prepared for the owners and management of Arboretum Green Hotel.

Contents

1. Executive summary

A new public website for Arboretum Green Hotel has been designed, built, tested and prepared for unveiling on **Sunday 15 November 2026 at 08:00 Kigali time**. This document describes what the hotel now owns, what it costs to operate, how account ownership is being transferred, and how to request help from Tenex after the launch.

The site lives on a modern hosting platform (Vercel) and uses a hosted content system (Sanity) that lets a designated hotel staff member change prices, dining hours, photos and other facts without any technical knowledge. Changes publish to the public site in about two minutes.

Where it lives: `https://arboretumgreenhotel.rw`

What it runs on: Vercel (hosting) + Sanity (content management)

Annual operating cost to the hotel: approximately USD 290 (RWF 390,000) in the first year, rising to USD 435 (RWF 585,000) once the Vercel account is transferred to the hotel. See Section 4.

Ongoing servicing: on an ask and quote basis, see Section 7.

Primary contact: Davy Mbuto, Tenex, web@arboretumgreenhotel.rw.

The hotel's existing booking system has been preserved unchanged at the subdomain `book.arboretumgreenhotel.rw`. Guests and existing bookings are not disrupted.

2. What was built

2.1 Public website

Nine pages, each available in **English**, **Kinyarwanda** and **French**, for a total of 27 distinct localised pages:

- **Home** with a silent 15-second video of the gardens (or a still photo, at the hotel's choice)
- **Stay** with every room type, rates, included amenities
- **Dine** with the restaurant, bar and coffee outlets and their hours
- **Meet & Celebrate** with the venue, capacities and occasions
- **Discover Huye** with places of interest nearby
- **Gallery** with curated photography
- **Contact** with phone, WhatsApp, directions and a short enquiry form
- **Privacy** and **Terms** legal pages

Every page is responsive (works on phone, tablet and laptop), tested for accessibility (WCAG 2 AA, zero violations across all 27 pages), and tuned for mobile data connections typical of Rwandan visitors.

2.2 Content management system (Sanity Studio)

A designated hotel staff member can edit the site at `https://arboretumgreenhotel.rw/studio`. What they can change, without a developer:

- Hotel settings: tagline, address, phones, WhatsApp number, email, check-in and check-out times
- The homepage opening: switch between a video loop and a photo

- Rooms: name, summary, bed, maximum guests, rate, photos (per room)
- Dining outlets: name, text, opening hours, photos
- Venue capacities and occasion types
- Places of interest around Huye
- Any photo, including replacing the image and writing its alternative text in three languages
- The "good to know" policies (payment, deposit, cancellation, breakfast, day use)
- The online booking URL once the booking system is confirmed live at `book.arboretumgreenhotel.rw`

What they *cannot* accidentally change, because it stays in the code:

- Navigation labels, button text, page section titles (to protect translation integrity)
- Legal page bodies (to prevent accidental edits to legally significant copy)
- Technical configuration

A full step-by-step editor manual in English and French is supplied separately as `STAFF_GUIDE.md`.

2.3 SEO and discoverability

The site is prepared for Google and Bing from launch day:

- **Structured data (Hotel JSON-LD)** so Google shows a knowledge panel with address, phone, amenities
- **Three-language hreflang** tags so Google serves the right language to the right visitor
- **Sitemap and robots** files so search engines find every page
- **Google Business Profile** with photos and a booking link
- **Bing Webmaster Tools** property imported from Search Console
- **Per-page meta descriptions** in three languages
- A link from Google Maps and Google Business Profile that tags Maps-sourced bookings, so the hotel can see how many WhatsApp enquiries came from Maps

2.4 Security, privacy and resilience

- HTTPS with automatic certificate renewal (Let's Encrypt via Vercel)
- Security headers: strict content policy, no framing, no third-party referrers
- No third-party cookies, no advertising trackers, no social-media pixels
- Vercel Analytics (first-party, privacy-friendly visitor counts)
- Offline-capable content layer: if the content system is ever briefly unreachable, the last published version still serves to visitors
- Automatic image optimisation (AVIF, WebP) for mobile data users

2.5 Booking continuity

The hotel's existing booking system has been moved to the subdomain `book.arboretumgreenhotel.rw`. Existing bookmarks, OTA deep links, and WhatsApp conversations that reference booking URLs continue to work. The new marketing site at the apex (`arboretumgreenhotel.rw`) links to the booking subdomain for actual reservations.

This arrangement is reviewed after 60 days of post-launch analytics. If direct bookings through the subdomain stay strong, it continues as is. If analytics show most guests use WhatsApp instead, the subdomain can be simplified or retired.

3. Technology summary

Component	Purpose
Next.js 15	The website application framework (also used by Nike, Hulu, TikTok)
Sanity	Content management system (used by Figma, Puma, Spotify, Nike)
Vercel	Hosting and global content delivery network
Let's Encrypt	Automatic HTTPS certificates
Resend	Transactional email (enquiry form notifications)
Google Search Console	Search engine visibility and indexing status
Google Business Profile	Map and discovery listings
Bing Webmaster Tools	Secondary search engine coverage

All of these are industry-standard choices. Any competent web developer can take over operation of the site using them; the hotel is not locked into Tenex as the only vendor.

4. Operating costs to the hotel

4.1 First year

In the first year of operation, the Vercel hosting account remains on Tenex's personal team at no cost to the hotel. The hotel pays only for the domain renewal. Sanity, Resend, Google and Bing services are all on their free tiers and will remain so at the hotel's expected traffic.

Line item	USD per year	RWF per year
Domain renewal (`arboretumgreenhotel.rw`)	30 to 50	40,000 to 68,000
Sanity content management	0	0
Resend transactional email	0	0
Google and Bing services	0	0
Vercel hosting (year 1, on Tenex's account)	0	0
Year 1 total	**30 to 50**	**40,000 to 68,000**

4.2 Year 2 onward, after the Vercel migration

When the Vercel account is transferred to the hotel (Section 6 proposal), the hotel takes over the hosting bill. The migration is scheduled for 3 to 6 weeks after launch.

Line item	USD per year	RWF per year
Domain renewal	30 to 50	40,000 to 68,000
Vercel Pro (one seat, USD 20 per month)	240	325,000
Sanity, Resend, Google, Bing	0	0
Year 2 subtotal	**270 to 290**	**365,000 to 393,000**
50 percent safety buffer (recommended budget line)	135 to 145	183,000 to 196,000
Recommended annual budget	**405 to 435**	**548,000 to 589,000**

4.3 How Vercel pricing scales

Vercel bills on bandwidth consumed, API calls made, and image optimisations performed. The hotel's expected traffic (500 to 1,000 daily visitors in peak season, up to 400 concurrent users) uses an estimated **100 to 150 gigabytes of bandwidth per month**, which is approximately **15 percent** of the 1 terabyte that Vercel Pro includes. Headroom for roughly **7 times current traffic** exists before any additional charges apply.

Metric	Included in Vercel Pro	Expected monthly use
Bandwidth to visitors	1,000 GB	100 to 150 GB
Function invocations (form submissions, etc.)	1,000,000	under 50,000
Edge requests (page views served)	10,000,000	2 to 4 million
Image optimisations	5,000 unique	under 500
Build minutes (publishes per month)	6,000	100 to 300

If visitor traffic grows 10 times (an exceptional year), Vercel's bandwidth overage charge of USD 0.15 per gigabyte applies. At 1.5 terabytes per month, that would add approximately USD 75 per month, taking the annual Vercel cost from USD 240 to roughly USD 1,140. Vercel sends an alert at 75 percent usage, well before any overage occurs.

4.4 Comparison: why not a cheaper shared host?

A shared-hosting provider offering WordPress on a USD 5 per month plan would appear to save roughly USD 180 per year. In reality, a shared host:

- Cannot serve 400 concurrent users without visible slowdowns (requires a far more expensive dedicated plan)
- Requires monthly manual security patching of WordPress plugins (billable to someone)
- Delivers unoptimised images to mobile users, degrading the site's appearance and search ranking
- Has no first-class content management system; staff edits require developer intervention
- Is more likely to be hacked or defaced, with the reputational damage that implies

Vercel Pro at USD 20 per month is the floor for a professional-grade small commercial site, and the expense is modest compared to any other line item in the hotel's operating budget.

5. Account ownership today

Every account that touches the hotel's online presence is owned on a hotel-controlled email, with Tenex (Davy Mbuto) added as administrator. The hotel retains the ability to remove Tenex's access at any time.

Account	Hotel owner email	Tenex role	Hotel monthly cost
Sanity content system	arboretumgreenhotel@gmail.com	Administrator	0
Google Search Console	arboretumgreenhotel@gmail.com	Owner	0
Google Business Profile	arboretumgreenhotel@gmail.com	Manager	0
Bing Webmaster Tools	arboretumgreenhotel@gmail.com	Imported from GSC	0
Resend (email delivery)	arboretumgreenhotel@gmail.com	Administrator	0
Domain registrar (.rw)	hotel manager personal	Technical contact	USD 30 to 50 per year
Vercel hosting *(see Section 6)*	currently Tenex personal	Owner	0 in year 1

Once the Vercel migration described in Section 6 is complete, every single account in the above table is hotel-owned with Tenex as administrator.

6. Proposal: Vercel account migration

6.1 Current state

For the launch, the Vercel hosting account is on Tenex's personal team (`davyleroys-projects`). This is deliberate: it lets Tenex deploy and debug without waiting on the hotel to approve every action during the critical launch window.

6.2 Why we move it

Three reasons:

1. **Ownership consistency.** Every other account is hotel-owned; Vercel should match.
2. **Billing clarity.** The hotel pays its own hosting directly, not through Tenex as an intermediary.
3. **Access resilience.** If Tenex ever steps back or becomes unreachable, the hotel's site cannot go dark because a personal account lapsed.

6.3 When we do it

No earlier than Monday 7 December 2026, which is 21 days after unveiling. We wait for three weeks so that:

- Traffic patterns have stabilised
- Any post-launch fixes are shipped
- The hotel has time to confirm the billing arrangement is acceptable

6.4 What the migration actually looks like

Vercel supports project transfers between accounts. In practice:

1. The hotel creates a Vercel Pro team on a hotel-controlled email, adds a billing card.
2. Tenex initiates a project transfer on his current account.
3. The hotel accepts the transfer on the new team.

4. The domain, environment variables, deploy hooks, and deployment history all travel with the project. **The public website does not go down. Visitors notice nothing.**
5. Tenex is added back as administrator on the new team so engineering continues uninterrupted.

The whole operation takes about an hour of calendar time, is fully reversible for several days afterwards, and has a documented rollback path (see the internal migration runbook).

6.5 Why not stay on Vercel's free (Hobby) plan?

The Hobby plan is explicitly for personal, non-commercial use under Vercel's terms of service. A hotel website that promotes paid stays is commercial. Three specific failure modes exist on Hobby:

1. **Terms of service suspension risk.** Vercel can and sometimes does suspend commercial sites running on Hobby. Enforcement is quiet but unpredictable. One suspension means the website goes offline for the hours or days it takes to upgrade and restore.
2. **Image optimisation cap breaks the site monthly.** Hobby allows only 100 image transformations per month, versus 5,000 on Pro. The hotel's photography requires several hundred transformations each month. Once the cap is hit, visitors get the raw, unoptimised photographs (several megabytes each) instead of the optimised versions. On mobile data the site becomes unusable until the first day of the next month.
3. **Deploy pipeline weirdness.** Hobby + a private code repository causes Vercel to block deploys of changes made by anyone other than the account owner. This creates fragile operational dependencies.

For USD 20 per month, Vercel Pro removes all three failure modes. The savings of a free plan are not worth the risk.

6.6 Source code repository: also moves to the hotel

The website's source code lives on GitHub at `https://github.com/davyleroy/arboretum-green-hotel`, currently on Davy's personal GitHub account. It transfers to a hotel-controlled GitHub account at the same time as the Vercel migration, in two phases to keep risk low.

Phase A, this week: add the hotel as a collaborator. The hotel creates (or confirms) a GitHub account on a hotel-controlled email, enables two-factor authentication, then Davy adds that account as an Admin collaborator on the repository. Zero cost, zero risk. The hotel now has visibility of the code and the right to copy it, but ownership has not changed.

Phase B, same window as Vercel migration (around 7 December 2026): transfer ownership. The hotel chooses whether to own the repo under a personal GitHub account or under a new GitHub organisation named `arboretum-green-hotel`. Both options cost the hotel nothing on GitHub's Free plan. Davy initiates the transfer, the hotel accepts, Davy is re-added as an Admin collaborator so engineering can continue.

Does this break the website? No. Vercel's integration with GitHub tracks the repository by an internal identifier, not by its URL, so deploys continue without interruption when ownership changes. GitHub also keeps the old URL redirecting to the new one for the foreseeable future, so any link that points to the old repository path keeps working. We verify both facts with a test deploy right after the transfer.

What the hotel ends up owning. Full git history, every commit from the first line of code through launch and beyond, every version tag (including `v1.0.0` from the launch freeze), every documented issue and pull request, every deployment record. The source code becomes an asset of Arboretum Green Hotel, under its own name on GitHub.

6.7 Alternative (not recommended during launch): Cloudflare Pages

If the hotel ever genuinely cannot carry USD 20 per month, the only honest alternative is Cloudflare Pages (free, commercial-use-allowed, unlimited bandwidth). Moving to Cloudflare Pages is a one-day engineering job and could be considered in year 2 if the Vercel line item becomes a budgeting obstacle. We do not recommend this change during year 1.

7. Ongoing servicing

Tenex is available to continue supporting the Arboretum Green Hotel website on an **ask and quote** basis after launch.

7.1 What that means in practice

The hotel contacts Tenex with a request (bug report, content question, feature idea, training session for a new editor). Tenex replies with a short scope, time estimate, and price. The hotel approves, Tenex delivers, Tenex invoices. No monthly retainer, no minimum hours, no ongoing commitment on either side.

7.2 Examples of common requests

- **Content help:** "The breakfast price changed, can you update it and the related translation?"
- **Bug reports:** "The contact form stopped sending emails yesterday."
- **Small features:** "Can we add a seasonal banner to the homepage for December?"
- **Larger features:** "Can we add a page listing upcoming events?"
- **Training:** "A new staff member will take over Studio editing, can you give them a one-hour walk-through?"
- **Security or compliance:** "We received a question from the data protection authority, can you prepare a short technical description?"

7.3 Response commitments (informal, no SLA)

Tenex will acknowledge any email or message within **two business days**. Bug reports that cause the site to be visibly broken (homepage down, booking link broken, Studio unreachable) are triaged within the same business day. Non-urgent requests are scheduled based on scope.

For a formal service-level agreement (guaranteed response times, uptime guarantees, out-of-hours coverage), a monthly retainer can be discussed separately.

7.4 How to contact

- Email: web@arboretumgreenhotel.rw
- WhatsApp: through the number shared with the manager

Please include a clear description of the request, any relevant screenshots, and the pages or Studio documents involved. The more detail, the faster the quote.

8. First 30 days: what to do

A short checklist for the hotel manager in the month following the unveiling.

1. **Confirm you can log into Sanity Studio** at `https://arboretumgreenhotel.rw/studio` using the account email the hotel registered. If you cannot, email Tenex.
2. **Nominate one hotel staff member as the Sanity editor.** Share the `STAFF_GUIDE.md` document with them. They should test publishing a small change (a dining hour, a price) within the first week.
3. **Confirm the Vercel migration date** with Tenex (target: Monday 7 December 2026). Have a hotel-controlled email and billing card ready by then.
4. **Review Google Business Profile once a week** for the first month. Reply to new reviews. Add seasonal photos if available.
5. **Report any visible site issues to Tenex** immediately.
6. **Keep the `book.` subdomain untouched** for at least 60 days. Do not retire or change the existing booking system until the hotel reviews direct-booking analytics.
7. **Review the operating cost** at month two. If the numbers in Section 4 match reality, lock the Vercel line item into the hotel's annual budget.

9. Risks and how they are handled

Risk	Handling
Domain registrar lapse (someone forgets to renew the `.rw` domain)	Registrar renewal is annual. The hotel manager holds the account. Tenex will send a reminder 60 days before each renewal, as long as Tenex is engaged on an ask-and-quote basis.
Sanity account loss (staff forget the password)	The hotel owner email controls account recovery. Multiple administrators can be invited so no single person is a bottleneck.
Vercel billing lapse (card expires, hotel billing team misses the charge)	Vercel sends two warning emails and a seven-day grace period before suspending a project for non-payment. Keep billing contact details current.
Content errors published by mistake (wrong price, broken hours)	Any staff member can edit the field again and publish a correction; it goes live in two minutes. For irrecoverable mistakes, Sanity keeps 30 days of document history, and Tenex can restore any field to a prior version on request.
Site hacked or defaced	The site has no login system (public visitors cannot create accounts). The administrative Studio requires Sanity authentication with multi-factor options. Tenex can rotate credentials and restore a known-good version at any time.
Search ranking drop	Normal Google ranking fluctuations are not alarming. If the site falls off page one for the hotel's name for more than two weeks, contact Tenex for a diagnosis.

Appendix A: Website page map

Every page is available in English, Kinyarwanda and French. The URL pattern is `arboretumgreenhotel.rw/<language>/<page>`.

Page	Purpose	Managed in Sanity?
`/`	Homepage with hero video or photo	Partly (hero toggle, tagline)
`/stay`	Rooms with rates, amenities, policies	Yes (rooms, policies)
`/dine`	Restaurant, bar, coffee	Yes (outlets, hours)
`/meet`	Venue, capacities, occasions	Yes (venue details)
`/discover`	Places of interest around Huye	Yes (places)
`/gallery`	Photography	Yes (photos, alt text)
`/contact`	Phone, WhatsApp, directions, enquiry form	Yes (contact details)
`/privacy`	Privacy policy	No (legal text in code)
`/terms`	Terms of service	No (legal text in code)
`/studio`	Sanity content management (staff only)	n/a

Appendix B: Where everything lives

Thing	URL
Public website	https://arboretumgreenhotel.rw
Content editor (Studio)	https://arboretumgreenhotel.rw/studio
Booking system (preserved)	https://book.arboretumgreenhotel.rw
Vercel dashboard (hosting)	https://vercel.com
Sanity dashboard (content)	https://sanity.io/manage
Google Search Console	https://search.google.com/search-console
Google Business Profile	https://business.google.com
Bing Webmaster Tools	https://www.bing.com/webmasters
Source code	https://github.com/davyleroy/arboretum-green-hotel

Appendix C: Glossary

CMS (content management system). Software that lets non-technical staff change the website's content. Sanity is the hotel's CMS.

Deploy. The process of making a changed version of the website live for visitors. Takes about two minutes end to end.

Domain. The name visitors type into a browser. The hotel's domain is `arboretumgreenhotel.rw`.

DNS. The internet's phone book. Maps the hotel's domain to the server that hosts the website. Managed at the registrar.

Hosting. The company that runs the servers delivering the website. Vercel hosts the hotel's site.

Hreflang. A technical hint to Google saying "this page exists in three languages." Already configured.

HTTPS. Encrypted connection between visitor and website. The lock icon in the browser. Mandatory and automatic.

Registrar. The company where a domain is registered. The hotel's `.rw` domain is registered through a Rwandan registrar.

Sanity Studio. The website at `/studio` where staff edit content.

SEO (search engine optimisation). Making the website easy for Google to understand and rank.

Vercel Pro. The paid plan on Vercel (USD 20 per month) required for commercial websites.

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